

GIWA MUHAMMAD

Senior Full-Stack Engineer · SaaS, Marketplaces & Payments Infrastructure

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Senior full-stack engineer with 5+ years building production SaaS, marketplaces, and the payments infrastructure underneath them — most of it owned solo from database schema to live deployment. Specialized in payments and multi-tenant platforms: escrow ledgers and split-payment flows (Stripe Connect, Paystack), subdomain-per-tenant architectures, event-driven microservices, and realtime systems, all shipped on real CI/CD pipelines.

Comfortable across Next.js / React on the front end and Node.js / TypeScript (with Go where it fits) on the back end, with a track record of full system ownership: architecture, data modeling, API performance, caching strategy, asynchronous processing, and production deployment.

CORE SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Go

Frontend: Next.js, React, Redux Toolkit, Vue.js, Tailwind CSS

Backend: Node.js, Express, TypeORM, REST APIs, Microservices

Payments: Stripe, Stripe Connect, Paystack, escrow & split-payment logic

Data: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis

Realtime & Async: Socket.io, BullMQ, RabbitMQ, Webhooks

Infrastructure: Docker, CI/CD (GitHub Actions), Cloudflare Workers, Nginx, Linux

Security: JWT Authentication, tenant-scoped RBAC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & CTO | SmartEdu

2026 – Present

- Lead product and engineering for a multi-tenant school-management SaaS platform serving schools across Africa.
- Architected a subdomain-per-tenant backend (Node.js, TypeORM, PostgreSQL) with Redis and BullMQ handling report generation, fee reminders, and payment reconciliation.
- Structured the frontend as a Turborepo of three Next.js applications sharing a component and design-token library.
- Integrated Paystack for fee collection, including installment plans and a platform-level revenue share on every transaction.
- Own the go-to-market materials and school onboarding process alongside the technical roadmap.

Senior Full-Stack Engineer, Architecture Lead | Raffles Energies

Jun 2024 – Apr 2025

- Led end-to-end architecture and backend development supporting web and mobile platforms.
- Architected and implemented the Node.js backend serving multiple client applications, with a relational schema and indexing strategy designed from inception.
- Built the API layer serving both web and mobile clients under sustained production traffic.
- Implemented Redis caching and query optimization that measurably reduced response latency.
- Designed asynchronous job processing and workflow-automation pipelines.
- Implemented JWT-based authentication and tenant-aware RBAC access control; containerized services and managed production deployment through structured, low-risk release cycles.

Backend Engineer | Centre for Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Sep 2023 – Mar 2024

- Scaled a Laravel-based LMS platform supporting multi-center operations for a government organization.
- Redesigned the relational schema to support expanded roles and institutional structure.
- Improved backend modularity and long-term maintainability, contributing to architectural-evolution discussions.

Full-Stack Engineer | Alphasol Limited

May 2023 – Aug 2023

- Led backend architecture and performance optimization for real-time operational systems.
- Designed RESTful APIs supporting real-time operational dashboards under continuous production load.
- Defined MongoDB and MySQL schema design and indexing strategies, improving query performance significantly.
- Implemented API caching strategies that reduced server load, JWT auth and role-based authorization, and contributed to CI/CD workflows enabling bi-weekly deployments.

Frontend & Backend Engineer | Nexlen Systems

Jan 2023 – Apr 2023

- Migrated a legacy Laravel Blade architecture into a structured Vue.js frontend system.
- Integrated the frontend with backend APIs, reduced redundant API calls, and improved UI performance.

SELECTED PROJECTS

StackMSP — Multi-Tenant Microservice SaaS Platform *Node.js, Go, PostgreSQL, Redis, RabbitMQ, Docker*

- Designed a distributed system of isolated microservices, each with its own independent PostgreSQL database and clean service boundaries.
- Implemented event-driven communication over RabbitMQ and a Redis caching layer to reduce API latency under load.
- Enforced a tenant-scoped RBAC model and secure JWT authentication at every service boundary; architected for horizontal scaling and fault isolation.

VerraEarth — Vetted Multi-Vendor Marketplace *Next.js, Redux Toolkit, Node.js, TypeORM, PostgreSQL, Stripe Connect*

- Built customer, vendor, and admin portals against a Node.js and TypeORM API.
- Implemented Stripe Connect split payments — platform fee, per-vendor transfers, and a delayed escrow-release service — with a vendor application and review queue gating storefronts.
- Added realtime messaging, a disputes flow, and support tickets between customers and vendors.

FairChild — Institutional Learning Management System *React, TypeScript, Node.js, TypeORM, PostgreSQL, Redis, Stripe*

- Led the build of a Node.js and TypeORM API modeling institution, instructor, staff, and student domains separately across ~100 entities.
- Built three React frontends (student, instructor, support), a Stripe-backed student wallet, and SCORM support.
- Shipped across dev, staging, and production with CI/CD, automated backups, and rollback.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Software Engineering | Nile University of Nigeria, Abuja